Reading and writing

2026-10-23 | Week 2 | Show what changed

Grade 3 | TEKS 3.8C, 3.7D

3.8C: Analyze plot elements, including the sequence of events, the conflict, and the resolution. In plain English: Explain the order of story events, the problem and how it is solved. 3.7D: Retell and paraphrase texts in ways that maintain meaning and logical order. In plain English: Retell or put a text into your own words while keeping its meaning and order. Today: Explain how a character's action changes what happens next.

Grade 4 | TEKS 4.8C, 4.7C

4.8C: Analyze plot elements, including the rising action, climax, falling action, and resolution. In plain English: Explain how a story builds to its turning point and moves toward a solution. 4.7C: Use text evidence to support an appropriate response. In plain English: Support an answer with something the text actually says or shows. Today: Use a detail from the story to explain a character's choice.

I Do

Book connection: Sequence the stuck-pumpkin problem, the group's attempts, and the shared solution. Read a short, accessible scene from Big Pumpkin. Show a visual sequence strip: beginning, middle, end. Ask the shared WH question, "Who is here, where are they, and what happens first?" Model pointing to a picture, choosing an answer card, using AAC or dictating a sentence. Then connect the same scene to each learner's target: Grade 3 explain how a character's action changes what happens next.; Grade 4 use a detail from the story to explain a character's choice..

We Do

Return to Big Pumpkin and use its pictures, props or vocabulary as the context. Reread the same scene aloud. Both learners use the same book, illustrations and three-part sequence mat. Ask who, what, where, when, why and how questions about the beginning, middle and end. Grade 3 arranges picture cards and answers with pointing, speech, AAC or dictation. Grade 4 explains the event, character action or evidence using the same page. Fade the model, switch teacher rotations, then revisit the visual sequence.

You Do

Use one fresh WH question about Big Pumpkin: "What happened at the beginning, middle or end, and how do you know?" Grade 3: Explain how a character's action changes what happens next. Grade 4: Use a detail from the story to explain a character's choice. Record the page or illustration, response mode, prompt level and whether the student identified the story-structure element.

Rotate and switch

Teacher with Grade 3 for 8-10 minutes while Grade 4 uses the taught independent task; switch. Match supports to each learner, not the grade label. Independent task: The learner not with the teacher uses a previously taught three-picture sequence, WH picture sort, character/setting match or known Vizzle task from Big Pumpkin. When finished, the learner may complete the week's book craft or quiet enrichment. The teacher then switches and teaches the other learner from the same scene.

Access and participation

Use objects or two clear choices, the learner's planned response method and wait time. Offer a private response or equivalent retry when needed; record extra help and no response separately.

Evidence and progress

Save one dated response for each grade's target above: a model/photo, selected answer, dictated sentence or work sample. Record correct / total and extra prompts separately. Use three fresh items for the Friday subject check. Use it for IEP progress only if it measures the actual goal under its required conditions; goals are awaiting upload.

Materials

Real books: Big Pumpkin. Bring the props and response mats in the weekly book guide.

Book connection for this subject

Big Pumpkin | Sequence the stuck-pumpkin problem, the group's attempts, and the shared solution.

Writing TEKS 3.7B

Write a response to a literary or informational text that demonstrates an understanding of a text.

Writing TEKS 4.7B

Write responses that demonstrate understanding of texts, including comparing and contrasting ideas across a variety of sources.

Writing and spelling

After the shared read-aloud and comprehension sequence, each learner makes an individual response from the same book. Grade 3: Explain how a character's action changes what happens next. Grade 4: Use a detail from the story to explain a character's choice. Offer large primary writing lines, a picture-to-sentence frame, tracing, dictation or AAC. Record composition separately from oral or picture evidence.

Visual WH and story-structure routine

Use the same book for both learners. Show who, what, where, when, why and how picture cards. Ask about the beginning, middle and end. Arrange three scene cards, then let each learner answer with pointing, AAC, speech, dictation or writing. Record the response mode and prompt level.

Craft or enrichment after comprehension

Create a lift-the-pumpkin paper chain showing each helper in order.

8-9 AM read-aloud

Room on the Broom by Julia Donaldson. Return to the real pages for evidence; see the weekly book guide.

Math

2026-10-23 | Week 2 | Show what changed

Grade 3 | TEKS 3.4H, 3.4J

3.4H: Determine the number of objects in each group when a set of objects is partitioned into equal shares or a set of objects is shared equally. In plain English: Find how many objects are in each group after sharing equally. 3.4J: Determine a quotient using the relationship between multiplication and division. In plain English: Use a related multiplication fact to solve a division problem. Today: Share 6 counters between 2 plates, then show how many are in each group.

Grade 4 | TEKS 4.5A

4.5A: Represent multi-step problems involving the four operations with whole numbers using strip diagrams and equations with a letter standing for the unknown quantity. In plain English: Represent multi-step problems using the four operations, diagrams and equations with a letter for the unknown. Today: Model 3 bags of 2 pencils, then give away 2. Choose operations and show 4 left; use n for the unknown when ready.

I Do

Book connection: Share pumpkin counters or seeds into equal groups and represent the groups with the week's operation. Grade 3: Share 8 counters between 2 plates; each plate receives 4. Connect the model to 8 / 2 = 4. Grade 4: Act out 2 bags with 3 pencils each, then give away 1 pencil. Build a strip diagram; connect it to (2 x 3) - 1 = n. Find 5 pencils left. Begin with one step if needed.

We Do

Return to Big Pumpkin and use its pictures, props or vocabulary as the context. Both students handle the shared materials. Practice one example with the teacher; then teach the two targets in separate rotations. Grade 3: after sharing 8 into 2 equal groups, use 2 x 4 = 8 to explain why 8 / 2 = 4.

You Do

Grade 3: Share 6 counters between 2 plates, then show how many are in each group. Grade 4: Model 3 bags of 2 pencils, then give away 2. Choose operations and show 4 left; use n for the unknown when ready.

Rotate and switch

Teacher with Grade 3 for 8-10 minutes while Grade 4 uses the taught independent task; switch. Match supports to each learner, not the grade label. Independent task: Complete a mastered counting/sorting tray or known Bridges practice task at the student's established level.

Access and participation

Use objects or two clear choices, the learner's planned response method and wait time. Offer a private response or equivalent retry when needed; record extra help and no response separately.

Evidence and progress

Save one dated response for each grade's target above: a model/photo, selected answer, dictated sentence or work sample. Record correct / total and extra prompts separately. Use three fresh items for the Friday subject check. Use it for IEP progress only if it measures the actual goal under its required conditions; goals are awaiting upload.

Materials

Counters, plates/cups and the linked math mat. Select the matching grade-level STEMscopes lesson. Use Bridges placement to choose a separate foundational intervention. Add a visual or prop from Big Pumpkin that represents this connection.

Book connection for this subject

Big Pumpkin | Share pumpkin counters or seeds into equal groups and represent the groups with the week's operation.

Science

2026-10-23 | Week 2 | Show what changed

Grade 3 | TEKS 3.7A, 3.7B

3.7A: Demonstrate and describe forces acting on an object in contact or at a distance, including magnetism, gravity, and pushes and pulls. In plain English: Show and explain pushes, pulls, gravity and magnetism, including forces that act without touching. 3.7B: Plan and conduct a descriptive investigation to demonstrate and explain how position and motion can be changed by pushing and pulling objects such as swings, balls, and wagons. In plain English: Plan and carry out a test showing how pushes and pulls change position or motion. Today: Show how a push or pull changes motion.

Grade 4 | TEKS 4.8A

4.8A: Investigate and identify the transfer of energy by objects in motion, waves in water, and sound. In plain English: Investigate how moving objects, water waves and sound transfer energy. Today: Observe energy moving from one object to another.

I Do

Book connection: Use a toy pumpkin or car to show how a push or pull changes position and motion. Roll a car into a second car on a flat taped track. Repeat three times.Grade 4: Roll one toy car into a stationary car. Predict, test and describe the movement of the second car as evidence of energy transfer.

We Do

Return to Big Pumpkin and use its pictures, props or vocabulary as the context. Complete three trials. Record prediction and observed result. Use the Friday science tasks to assess during the investigation. Grade 3 chooses a push or pull to test, predicts the position change, marks the start, tries it and describes the observed result.

You Do

Grade 3: Show a push or pull that changes the car's position. Grade 4: Repeat with a fresh trial and identify where energy transferred.

Rotate and switch

Teacher with Grade 3 for 8-10 minutes while Grade 4 uses the taught independent task; switch. Match supports to each learner, not the grade label. Independent task: Sort familiar object/photo matches away from the experiment station. Experiments are adult supervised.

Access and participation

Use objects or two clear choices, the learner's planned response method and wait time. Offer a private response or equivalent retry when needed; record extra help and no response separately.

Evidence and progress

Save one dated response for each grade's target above: a model/photo, selected answer, dictated sentence or work sample. Record correct / total and extra prompts separately. Use three fresh items for the Friday subject check. Use it for IEP progress only if it measures the actual goal under its required conditions; goals are awaiting upload.

Materials

Two toy cars, tape, flat board, counters, plates, cups, pencil or craft-stick set. Adult manages circuit parts, magnets, small items and warm materials; use a low-voltage kit only. Add a visual or prop from Big Pumpkin that represents this connection.

Book connection for this subject

Big Pumpkin | Use a toy pumpkin or car to show how a push or pull changes position and motion.

Friday investigation

Pumpkin push investigation: use a lightweight pumpkin model on a tray. Grade 3 predicts and compares a push and pull (3.7B). Grade 4 rolls a toy car into the stationary model and observes energy transfer (4.8A). Repeat three trials with the same surface. Save one prediction, observation and explanation per learner.

Social studies

2026-10-23 | Week 2 | Show what changed

Grade 3 | TEKS 3.9A

3.9A: Identify characteristics of good citizenship, including truthfulness, justice, equality, respect for oneself and others, responsibility in daily life, and participation in government by educating oneself about the issues, respectfully holding public officials to their word, and voting. In plain English: Recognize responsible citizenship, including honesty, fairness, respect and participation in government. Today: Show one example of responsibility with evidence.

Grade 4 | TEKS 4.2A

4.2A: Summarize motivations for European exploration and settlement of Texas, including economic opportunity, competition, and the desire for expansion. In plain English: Explain why Europeans explored and settled Texas, including opportunity, competition and expansion. Today: Match an explorer, motivation and result.

I Do

Book connection: Match each character to a team role and explain how cooperation helps the group. Grade 3: Show one example of responsibility with evidence. Model with one district source, naming the visible clue. Grade 4: Match an explorer, motivation and result. Use the current Texas history map, image or excerpt; name the person/event and point to the evidence.

We Do

Return to Big Pumpkin and use its pictures, props or vocabulary as the context. Work together with a second example from the same source set. One source, one question, one product. Keep accuracy and prompting separate. Keep the grade-specific question visible and fade added hints.

You Do

Grade 3: Show one example of responsibility with evidence. Grade 4: Match an explorer, motivation and result. Use a fresh source/card; accept a model, pointing, AAC or a spoken explanation.

Rotate and switch

Teacher with Grade 3 for 8-10 minutes while Grade 4 uses the taught independent task; switch. Match supports to each learner, not the grade label. Independent task: Match two familiar source pictures or complete a known picture-to-object task.

Access and participation

Use objects or two clear choices, the learner's planned response method and wait time. Offer a private response or equivalent retry when needed; record extra help and no response separately.

Evidence and progress

Save one dated response for each grade's target above: a model/photo, selected answer, dictated sentence or work sample. Record correct / total and extra prompts separately. Use three fresh items for the Friday subject check. Use it for IEP progress only if it measures the actual goal under its required conditions; goals are awaiting upload.

Materials

District source pictures or excerpts, two-event sequence mat and writing/history frames. The classroom texts do not replace Texas history sources. Add a visual or prop from Big Pumpkin that represents this connection.

Book connection for this subject

Big Pumpkin | Match each character to a team role and explain how cooperation helps the group.